

Google TV being blocked

Certain networks in the US are blocking access to content on Google TV

line technology for a bargain, think again. You're buying from a business, not a charitable organization, so money is still being made – by the manufacturer, the retailer, and even the guys who sell refreshments at higher prices in crowded areas on hot days. Sorry, I digressed, but hate being ripped off, don't you?

In order to best understand how you could be ripped off, I've spent the last month window shopping, talking to shop keepers and people inside the business, and trying to figure out whether or not there really are any good deals out there. I started at the beginning, looking at what was on offer, and then trying to figure out how good or bad this deal was.



Look out for free bundles for camera in the lower price brackets

Are prices really lower?

Since Google searches spike the most during the Diwali season, it's obvious that hordes of us are out there buying. The most common way of marketing the offers is to describe them as rock-bottom prices, and in terms of percentage discounts.

What the deal?

Like any other year, some categories will have hot deals, and others will not. The festival of Dussera in November gave me an idea of the kind of deals we can expect this Diwali. I had my work cut out for me. Stacks of newspapers and brochures have since flooded my room, and my walls are covered with advertisements that I've been decoding, and then sorting as "Shop" or "Stop".



Free bundled memory cards are great, but only beyond a certain capacity

The most popular type of deal is the whole "discount" one. These are always on MRPs, which is good if it's on eatables, but completely useless in the consumer tech world. Not one of us should pay MRP for tech shopping. Ever!

Don't get suckered into believing that sign that screams "50% Discount". More often than not, the products with such high discounts are older models, and the discount you're actually getting on the product is more likely to be about 5 to 10 per cent the market operating price (MOP).

Another popular way of pushing stuff on to you is freebies. Although what follows is just an example, you should soon be able to start thinking along these lines for most of these "Free abc worth ₹xyz" deals.

Let's say you want to buy a TV, and there's an offer for a free digital photo frame, worth ₹6,000 with it. The best way to confront such deals is to go look at the prices of photo frames. If not in that retail store,



Mobiles phones are popular all through the year, so price drops are rare


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